

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	CHC4151/CHC4151P
Subject Title	Museum Studies and Cultural Management 博物館研究與文化管理
Credit Value	3
Level	4
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	CHC4151P/CHC4151P
Objectives	In the past decade, the number of cultural institutions, especially museums and art galleries, in Hong Kong and mainland China has proliferated to catch up with the socio-economic development. They play a fundamental role in satisfying the cultural, educational and leisure needs of urban residents, also boosting the tourism and economy significantly. The cultivation of management talents and career skills for related personnel and the study of relevant theories have also become a key concern for academics and the cultural industry. This course aims to offer the students, who are well-equipped in their knowledge in art history, history and culture, an introduction to the up-to-date theories and practices in museum studies and cultural management in the region and beyond. It will familiarize the students with the structure and operating mechanism of museums and other cultural institutions and enable them acquiring the capacity to quickly acclimate themselves to the working environment of these institutions. Major museological theories and pragmatic knowledges on museum management, collection management, curatorial planning, exhibition design, education program design, heritage preservation and prospects for both cultural policies and the cultural industry in present-day will be studied. The course cover industry-based subjects and museum administration topics while exploring, in-depth, contemporary issues and cases in Hong Kong, Mainland China and abroad.
Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 1)	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) Recognize trends, basic theories, structures of museum studies and cultural management in both local and global context

	b) Gain the basic skills in the classification, curation, conservation and display of objects and knowledge c) learn to interpret, define, communicate, and advocate for the dignity, values and cultural rights of all members of society d) Conduct independent research in a museum studies context e) Develop the skill set to manage programs and resources that preserve and publicly present cultural and natural heritage in non-profit and for-profit arts and cultural organizations and such as fine art museums, history museums, science museums and natural history museums in both local and national context
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1. Introduction to Museums: History, Structure and Functions 2. Theories and Methodologies in Museology 3. Museum Management: Founding and Operating a Museum 4. Collection Management: Accession, Registration and Conservation 5. Museum Curatorial I: Building and Managing the Collections 6. Museum Curatorial II: Developing Exhibitions and Storytelling 7. Museum Exhibition Design: Experience, Visual and Space 8. Fieldtrip to local museum to evaluate an exhibition 9. Museum Education and Programming: Object-based learning and Outreach 10. Cultural Heritage: Preservation and Development 11. Cultural Industries and Policies in Hong Kong, mainland China and Beyond: Gallery, Auction House, Exhibition Firm and Heritage Center 12. Real Practices: Guest lecture and Interactive Workshop by museum professional
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	The course comprises lectures, tutorial sessions, fieldtrip and group project. It emphasizes both the research skill needed for presenting relevant content in an exhibition zone and a holistic understanding of the role of different units within a museum. Student will read assigned readings before class and discuss issues brought up in the lecture. There is a fieldtrip for students to visit selected exhibition. Students submit evaluation report of the exhibition after the visit according to the standards taught in class. Students work in groups to develop an exhibition on a theme/venue of their choice. They need to present the exhibition in class and submit a package comprising an exhibition script, an object list with conservation notes, a layout plan and design notes.

**Assessment Methods
in Alignment with
Intended Learning
Outcomes**

(Note 4)

Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
		a	b	c	d	e	
1. In-class Assessment	10	✓	✓				
2. Mid-term Test	30	✓	✓	✓			
3. Field-trip Report	10	✓	✓	✓		✓	
4. Guest lecture/ practical workshop reflective essay	10		✓			✓	
5. Curatorial Project and Presentation	40		✓	✓	✓	✓	
Total	100 %						

Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:

1. In-class assessment helps to assess students' degree of dedication to the course, active reflections on the reading material and ability to present coherently and respond appropriately
2. Mid-term test timely gauges students' learning ability and preferences while enables teacher to adjust their teaching in the second half of the semester
3. Fieldtrip report tests student's systematic understanding of the key discourses on museum exhibition as well as their capacity to actively apply the knowledge to evaluate real exhibitions which prepares them for the final curatorial project
4. The guest lecture/workshop reflective essay enable the students to learn about real practices in the field and compare them with the best practices taught in class to understand the scheme of unavoidable compromises
5. The curatorial group project, in the form of creating an exhibition package, best assess students' systematic understanding of the museum structure and their ability to deliver the key cultural service provided by museums which entails the integration of knowledges and skills in at least four museum professions: management, collections, curatorial and design.

**Student Study Effort
Expected**

Class contact:	
▪ Lecture	25Hrs.
▪ Tutorial/Seminar	11Hrs.
▪ Fieldtrip	3Hrs.

	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Reading	35Hrs.
	▪ Writing	27Hrs.
	▪ Discussion	15Hrs.
	Total student study effort	116Hrs.
Reading List and References	• Alexander, E. P., Alexander, M., & Decker, J. (2017). <i>Museums in Motion: An Introduction to the History and Functions of Museums</i> (Vol. Third edition). Lanham, Maryland: Rowman & Littlefield Publishers. • Ambrose, T., & Paine, C. (2012). <i>Museum Basics</i> (Vol. 3rd ed). Abingdon, Oxon: Routledge. • Arrowsmith, R. (2011) <i>Modernism and the Museum: Asian, African, and Pacific Art and the London Avant-Garde</i>. Oxford: Oxford University Press. • Bennett, T. (1995). <i>The Birth of the Museum: History, Theory, Politics</i>. London and New York: Routledge. • Bourriaud, N. (2006) <i>Postproduction: Culture as Screenplay: How Art Reprograms the World</i>, Lukas & Sternberg. • Collective. (2020) <i>Protecting Asia's Heritage: Yesterday and Tomorrow</i>, Silkworm Books - Siam Society. • Denton, K. <i>Exhibiting the Past: Historical Memory and the Politics of Museums in Post-socialist China</i>, University of Hawaii Press, 2013, 250 pages • Genoways, H. H., Ireland, L. M., & Catlin-Legutko, C. (2016). <i>Museum Administration 2.0</i>. Lanham, MD: Rowman & Littlefield Publishers. • G., Lord & B. Lord. (2009). <i>The Manual of Museum Management</i>. Lanham, MD: AltaMira Press. • Johnson, A., Huber, K. A., Cutler, N., Bingmann, M., & Grove, T. (2017). <i>The Museum Educator's Manual: Educators Share Successful Techniques</i> (Vol. Second edition). Lanham, Maryland: Rowman & Littlefield Publishers. • Landry, Charles and Franco Bianchini. "The Urban Crisis and the Role of Creativity in Cities", In <i>The Creative City: A Toolkit for Urban Innovators</i>, 11-16. London: Demos, 1995. • Latham, K., & Simmons, J. (2014). <i>Foundations of Museum Studies: Evolving Systems of Knowledge : Evolving Systems of Knowledge</i>. Santa Barbara: Libraries Unlimited.	

	• Macleod, S., Austin T., Hale, J., and Ho, H (2018). <i>The Future of Museum and Gallery Design</i>. London: Routledge. • Mckenna-Cress, P. & Kamien J. (2013). <i>Creating Exhibitions</i>. Hoboken: New Jersey: John Wiley and Sons, Inc. • Piacente, M., & Lord, B. (2014). <i>Manual of Museum Exhibitions</i> (Vol. Second edition). Lanham, Maryland: Rowman & Littlefield Publishers. • Portnova, T. (2019). "Information Technologies in Art Monuments Educational Management and the New Cultural Environment for Art Historian." <i>TEM Journal</i>, 8(1), 189–194. https://doi.org/10.18421/TEM81-26 • Said, E. <i>Orientalism</i>. (2003). New York City: Penguin Classics. • Self, R. (2014). <i>The Architecture of Art Museums: A Decade of Design: 2000 - 2010</i>. London: Routledge. • Smith, L. <i>Uses of Heritage</i>, London: Routledge, 2006. • Sonoda, Naoko (2016). <i>New Horizons for Asian Museums and Museology</i>, Springer. • Tythacott, Louise. <i>Collecting and Displaying China's 'Summer Palace' in the West, The Yuanmingyuan in Britain and France</i>, Routledge, 2017. • Tzortzi, K. (2015). <i>Museum Space: Where Architecture Meets Museology</i>. Farnham, Surrey, England: Routledge.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

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